

Speech

People can communicate with each other using speech. The sounds we speak are produced by special breathing movements. These send bursts of air through the sound-creating vocal cords found in the throat.

Making sounds

During normal breathing the vocal cords are pulled open to allow air to be breathed in and out. While we are speaking, muscles pull the vocal cords together. When air is pushed between the closed vocal cords, they vibrate and produce sounds.

The **larynx**, or voice box, links the throat to the trachea, or windpipe, and contains the vocal cords. It is made from pieces of cartilage.

Vocal cords stretch from the front to the back of the larynx

Rings of cartilage hold the trachea open

Vocal cords
pulled closed

Trachea carries air to and from the lungs

